



Brunei



Myanmar (Burma)

SOUTHEAST ASIA

It is hard to get away from water in most parts of Southeast Asia! The twelve countries that make up the region are linked by waterways and surrounded by oceans. The hot, wet environment is ideal for farming rice, the staple crop of the region. It also supports large areas of tropical rainforests. Sadly, heavy logging has forced many forest people to move into towns, where the way of life is very different.

People power

The Penan people live in the rainforests of Sarawak. They have tried to stop the destruction of their forest home by blocking roads into the rainforest. Sarawak has the world's highest rate of logging.



Living with water

Many houses in Malaysia and Indonesia are built on stilts. This helps protect them from floods during torrential rainstorms.

The houses are called "long" houses. Behind each door is a large room, or "bilik," where the family lives.



The secret of success

The small island state of Singapore is a powerful trading nation. Singapore became successful because of its position. It was built up as a key trading post between the Far East and the West, and is now one of Asia's richest countries.

The houses are made both from natural and modern materials. Some roofs are made from palms, others from corrugated iron.

